

Question:

A 60-year-old woman is brought to the emergency department because of altered mental status for 2 hours. She and her husband were at the grocery store when she suddenly could not remember why she was there or how she got there. She has not had any head trauma. She has a history of depression and migraines. She does not smoke and drinks a glass of wine each night with dinner. She takes fluoxetine daily. She appears distressed and anxious. Her vital signs are within normal limits. She is fully alert and oriented to self and place but not to time. Every few minutes she asks how she got to the emergency department. She is able to follow commands and sustain attention. She recalls 3/3 objects immediately and recalls 0/3 objects at 5 minutes. The remainder of the neurological exam shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Transient global amnesia
- B. Depersonalization/derealization disorder
- C. Seizure
- D. Migraine

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The question is asking for the most likely diagnosis for a 60-year-old woman with altered mental status .

To answer this question , we need to identify the key features of the patient's presentation and history .

The patient has a history of depression and migraines , but her current symptoms are more consistent with a memory disorder rather than a mood or headache disorder .

The patient's ability to be fully alert and oriented to self and place , but not to time , suggests a disorder of time perception or memory .

The patient's ability to recall objects immediately but not at 5 minutes suggests a disorder of short-term memory .

The patient's history of not having any head trauma and normal neurological exam makes a seizure less likely .

Depersonalization/derealization disorder is not typically associated with memory deficits .

Transient global amnesia is a disorder of short-term memory that is typically associated with alterations in consciousness and confusion , which is not present in this patient .

Therefore , the most likely diagnosis is migraine , as it is a common cause of transient memory deficits and is consistent with the patient's history of migraines . </think><answer> Migraine </answer>